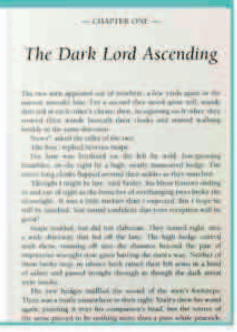
REAL WORLD

Once upon a time...

Fiction writers need to write good opening lines to draw readers into the story. For example, the author J.K. Rowling starts the first chapter of *Harry Potter and the Deathly Hallows* with these lines: "The two men appeared out of nowhere, a few yards apart in the narrow, moonlit lane."


— CHAPTER ONE —

The Dark Lord Ascending

Topic sentences

It can be effective to start a paragraph with a topic sentence. This is a statement that introduces the main idea in the paragraph. The rest of the paragraph needs to expand on the topic sentence or give evidence to back it up. This method can help keep a piece of writing focused.

The health benefits of regular exercise cannot be ignored.

This bold statement is a topic sentence. The rest of the paragraph will discuss the health benefits that it refers to.

Overall, there is no excuse. Getting regular exercise will reduce your chances of developing heart disease and other serious illnesses. In the short term, it will make you healthier, happier, and more energetic. Finally, it's an excellent way to meet new people, have fun, and perhaps discover a new talent.

A conclusion should make a decisive final statement.

Link a conclusion back to points in the introduction to give the piece cohesion.

- Referring **back** to points made in previous paragraphs makes a piece of writing more **connected** because it shows that the piece has been considered as a whole.
- Do not make **completely new** points in a conclusion.

A lasting impression

A conclusion should repeat the main points.

A conclusion should summarize the main points made in a piece of writing and make a decisive judgment about the topic. It should refer back to the original question and, ideally, any points made in the introduction. A sophisticated conclusion can end by referring to the wider implications of the question, and leave the reader with something to think about.

If you start now, perhaps you could be climbing the Olympic podium one day.

A final, memorable statement in a piece of writing is sometimes called a "clincher."

Seamless links

A good piece of writing should be cohesive. This means that the sentences, paragraphs, and ideas are all linked together in a flowing way. Sentences and paragraphs can be connected using linking words or phrases. However, use these sparingly.

on the other hand
by contrast
however
nevertheless

to contrast one idea with another

therefore
thus
as a result of
accordingly

to give logical reasons

first
next
first of all
finally

to order ideas in a sequence

also
moreover
furthermore
in addition

to develop an idea